FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-24008

Issue Title : 737MAX Unexpected Loss of CPDLC connection while flying westbound through North Atlantic (NAT) airspace

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3461-00	-10, -7, -8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
09/22/2025	11/05/2025	10/31/2025
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
01/31/2027	10/31/2026	

Revision Description

Updated “Milestones" Root Caused Established: June - 2025 (Completed)

Description

Operators have reported unexpected loss of Controller Pilot Data Link Communications (CPDLC) connection while flying westbound and eastbound oceanic flights through North Atlantic (NAT) airspace while logged on to Future Air Navigation System (FANS) 1/A CPDLC centers. The reported configuration includes Flight Management Computer (FMC) with U14/14.1 that includes Loading Software Airplane Part #’s 650630-002 / 650630-004 and 650631-15-01, Future Air Navigation System (FANS-2) FMC OPC option #50 enabled with a Honeywell Mk2+ CMU and utilizing the Iridium SATCOM network. Since the CPDLC functionality has not been modified from U14 to U14.1, these issues are most likely found with U14, but have not been reported.

Boeing has received reports of the sudden loss of CPDLC while there is consistent ACARS traffic over the Iridium network while traversing NAT airspace. These issues include unexpected CPDLC terminations (often followed by an inability to re-logon) and reported instances where it appears the crew has successfully logged on, only to find that uplink and downlink messages are not being delivered.

Status

Boeing, Honeywell, and GE have root caused this issue to be caused by an ATN specific protocol between the FMC and CMU. The CMU sends periodic ATN DSI (Dialogue Service Interface) protocol messages that the FMC must acknowledge. In the presence of Iridium SATCOM network delays, the FMC will fail to acknowledge these messages, causing the CMU to detect a protocol error and send a sync word such that the FMC incorrectly terminates the FANS CPDLC connection and prevents subsequent logon attempts while the delays exist. A fix is planned to be incorporated into upcoming software Blockpoint U14.2.

Interim Action

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No interim work-around is available. Boeing/GE request operators to report unexpected CPDLC disconnects while flying westbound through NAT. Boeing request operators to provide the event information including the FMC BITE, Date, Tail, Flight Number and Approximate Time. Also, provide the raw network datalink audits or permission to access the datalink audits directly from your network provider.

Final Action

Boeing will issue a Service Bulletin for FMC U14.2.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: June - 2025 (Completed)

Change Committed: FMC U14.2, ECD - TBD

Service Bulletin Available: TBD

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737NG-FTD-34-23003		

Related Categories

- Flight Operations : Flight Operations

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